

HUNT • MONTAGUE • FANNIN • LAMAR • COLLIN • DALLAS
• JOHNSON • WISE AND THE COUNTIES BETWEEN THEM
2026 EDITION

NORTH TEXAS INFRASTRUCTURE & ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT ATLAS

MAJOR PROJECTS ACROSS 18 COUNTIES
WITHIN 60 MILES OF DALLAS

TXDOT UTP • NTTA BOARD ACTIONS • MOBILITY 2050
• NTMWD CAPITAL PLANS • CITY EDCS



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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY



North Texas is in the middle of the largest sustained infrastructure buildout in its history. Across the eighteen counties profiled in this report — spanning roughly a 60-mile radius from downtown Dallas, from Montague and Wise in the northwest to Fannin and Lamar in the northeast, from Hunt in the east to Johnson and Hood in the south — TxDOT, the North Texas Tollway Authority, the North Texas Municipal Water District, Dallas Area Rapid Transit, and dozens of city and county economic development corporations are simultaneously executing tens of billions of dollars in funded, under-construction, or newly approved projects.

This report profiles that buildout county by county, drawing on the primary planning record: TxDOT's Unified Transportation Program and district construction/design project lists, NTTA board meeting agendas and approved contracts, the North Central Texas Council of Governments' Mobility 2050 metropolitan transportation plan and its 2026 administrative revisions, NTMWD's capital improvement program, and the economic development corporation announcements, incentive agreements, and council actions of the region's cities.

Five themes emerge from this record. First, the interstate system is being rebuilt almost everywhere at once — I-30 through downtown Dallas and across Lake Ray Hubbard into Rockwall and Hunt counties, I-35E and I-35W through Dallas, Denton, Tarrant, and Ellis counties, and I-20/I-820 through Tarrant County, together representing well over \$6 billion in active or newly let construction. Second, the tollway network is extending outward in every direction — the Dallas North Tollway north through Collin into Grayson County, and the Chisholm Trail Parkway south through Johnson County — while NTTA simultaneously maintains and modernizes its existing 90-plus-mile system. Third, water is now as consequential as pavement: NTMWD's \$1.7 billion 2026 capital program, anchored by twin \$605 million pipelines moving Lake Texoma water south and a \$240 million pipeline extending Bois d'Arc Lake service east, is the infrastructure story most likely to determine which exurban counties can actually accommodate the growth headed their way.

Fourth, private capital is arriving at a scale that dwarfs most public projects — Google's \$40 billion Texas investment centered on twin Ellis County data center campuses, Globe Life's headquarters relocation and Encore Wire's \$500 million expansion in McKinney, and the Texas Stock Exchange's launch in downtown Dallas are each, individually, larger than most of the highway projects in this report. Fifth, the buildout has a clear geographic gradient: funded, under-construction infrastructure concentrates inside the core five counties (Dallas, Collin, Denton, Tarrant, Rockwall), while the outer ring (Wise, Montague, Fannin, Lamar, Hunt, Navarro, and the Van Zandt/Hopkins/Delta corridor) is earlier-stage — feasibility studies, thoroughfare plans, and initial widenings rather than finished interstates — which is precisely where the region's next decade of growth is being positioned today.

METHODOLOGY AND SCOPE



GEOGRAPHIC SCOPE

This report profiles major infrastructure and economic development projects across eighteen counties within approximately 60 miles of downtown Dallas, organized in four tiers by their position in the regional growth pattern:

CORE METROPLEX (5 COUNTIES)

Dallas, Collin, Denton, Tarrant, Rockwall — the fully urbanized center of the region, where nearly all major projects are funded and under construction.

INNER RING (5 COUNTIES)

Kaufman, Ellis, Johnson, Parker, Wise — the suburbanizing counties directly adjacent to the core, where highway capacity is racing to keep pace with rooftop growth.

NAMED PRIORITY COUNTIES, OUTER RING (4 COUNTIES)

Hunt, Fannin, Montague, Lamar — specifically requested for this report, representing the northern and northeastern frontier where reservoir development, highway widenings, and small-city economic development programs are converting agricultural land into the region's next growth tier.

EXTENDED WATCH TIER (4 COUNTIES)

Grayson, Cooke, Hood, and the Navarro/Van Zandt/Hopkins/Delta corridor — counties at or near the edge of the 60-mile radius, included for completeness because each intersects a major regional corridor (US-75/US-82 into Oklahoma, I-35 north, US-377 southwest, and I-20/I-30 east).

SOURCES

This report synthesizes the primary public planning record as of mid-2026: TxDOT's 2026 Unified Transportation Program (draft and adopted), district-level construction and design project lists for the Dallas, Fort Worth, Paris, and Wichita Falls districts, and individual project fact sheets and public hearing notices; NTTA board of directors meeting agendas and approved construction/materials-testing contracts; NCTCOG's Mobility 2050 metropolitan transportation plan, adopted June 12, 2025, and its 2026 administrative revisions and Regional 10-Year Plan updates; NTMWD's fiscal year 2026 capital improvement program announcements; and city and county economic development corporation announcements, incentive agreements, tax increment reinvestment zone filings, and council actions across the profiled counties. Dollar figures, completion dates, and project statuses reflect the most recent public reporting available and should be independently verified before any transaction or investment decision — public infrastructure timelines and budgets are routinely revised.

PART I: REGIONAL SYSTEMS



TXDOT'S UNIFIED TRANSPORTATION PROGRAM

The Unified Transportation Program is TxDOT's rolling ten-year statewide project authorization document, updated annually. The 2026 UTP cycle, released in draft in mid-2025 and finalized for the current fiscal year, authorizes well over \$800 million in Dallas County construction alone and comparable or larger sums across the Fort Worth, Paris, and Wichita Falls districts covered in this report. The single most consequential structural feature of the UTP for a county like Hunt, Fannin, or Van Alstyne-adjacent Grayson is Tier One categorization: a project that clears TxDOT's Tier One threshold in the 10-Year Unified Transportation Program has cleared the state's highest-confidence funding and engineering commitment, and is the closest thing this region has to a guarantee that a specific road will be built on a specific timeline.

NTTA AND THE TOLL NETWORK

The North Texas Tollway Authority operates roughly 90 miles of tollway across the region and is simultaneously extending two of its four major systems outward: the Dallas North Tollway's Phase 4 extension north of US-380 toward the Grayson County line, and the Chisholm Trail Parkway's widening from two to four lanes south into Johnson County. NTTA's board approves construction, materials-testing, and maintenance contracts on a rolling monthly basis (regular board meetings occur most months, with committee and special sessions as needed), and its meeting minutes are consequently one of the highest-signal, lowest-latency sources for tracking which segment of the tollway network is about to move from planning to construction.

MOBILITY 2050 AND THE REGIONAL TRANSPORTATION COUNCIL

Mobility 2050 is NCTCOG's federally required long-range metropolitan transportation plan for the sixteen-county Dallas-Fort Worth planning area, adopted by the Regional Transportation Council on June 12, 2025. It is the umbrella document that reconciles every TxDOT, NTTA, DART, and county road project in the region into a single financially constrained plan, and it is amended through periodic administrative revisions — a February 2026 draft revision cycle updated the plan's Regional 10-Year Project List (covering FY2026–FY2035) and its inventory of non-regionally-significant arterial and roadway projects. For any project in this report not yet in construction, its presence in — or absence from — the current Mobility 2050 project list is the clearest available signal of whether it is a real, financially constrained commitment or an aspirational county thoroughfare-plan entry.

NTMWD'S CAPITAL PROGRAM

The North Texas Municipal Water District will invest an estimated \$1.7 billion in fiscal year 2026 alone, with more than \$1.3 billion of that directed at water supply reliability — principally the "Texoma Two-Step" program, which pairs twin \$605 million pipelines moving additional raw water from Lake Texoma to the Wylie and Leonard treatment plants with a \$240 million pipeline extending Bois d'Arc Lake supply east across the district's service area.

Both pipeline construction contracts are slated for award in October 2026, with construction beginning late in the year, and both carry Texas Water Development Board low-interest financing expected to save member cities and customers up to \$95 million versus conventional financing. For the thirteen member cities and the broader collar of counties they serve, this program is arguably a more binding constraint on growth than any single highway project in this report: water capacity, not road capacity, is increasingly the gating factor on new residential and industrial development across the district's territory.

REGIONAL TRANSIT: DART AND THE SILVER LINE

Dallas Area Rapid Transit's Silver Line — the 26-mile Cotton Belt regional rail corridor connecting East Plano to DFW International Airport's Terminal B through Addison, Carrollton, Coppell, Dallas, Grapevine, and Richardson — reached roughly 85 percent construction completion heading into 2026, with revenue service targeted for late 2025 into early 2026. It is the first regional rail line to directly connect Collin, Dallas, and Tarrant counties without routing through downtown Dallas, and its ten new stations are already visible in adjacent land-use and zoning activity in Addison, Carrollton, and Coppell.

PART II: CORE METROPLEX COUNTIES



DALLAS COUNTY

Dallas County is where the largest number of individually massive projects converge, spanning highway reconstruction, transit, and some of the largest private capital commitments in the region's history.

TRANSPORTATION.

The I-30 Canyon project is reconstructing the underutilized collector-distributor roads and widening I-30's main lanes through downtown between I-35E and I-45 to address the corridor's worst bottleneck.

The Southern Gateway project, a \$666 million design-build rebuild and widening of I-35E south of downtown (plus US-67 between I-35E and I-20), is substantially complete, with the Southern Gateway deck park, Harold Simmons Park's Halperin Park segment, slated to open in spring 2026. I-345 is receiving \$20.5 million in bridge widening and maintenance from the I-30 interchange to Spur 366 — notable both as a standalone project and as the current, funded phase of a corridor whose long-term future (rebuild versus removal) remains one of the most closely watched planning questions in the city. Additional funded work includes \$28.7 million in US-175 rehabilitation from Bexar Street to Belt Line Road and \$20 million in I-35 rehabilitation between Northwest Highway and I-635. In total, more than \$800 million in Dallas County TxDOT construction is active or newly let as of 2026.

TRANSIT

DART's Silver Line (Cotton Belt) reaches its Dallas segments as part of the broader 26-mile regional rail line described in Part I, and downtown Dallas remains the system's core hub.

ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT

The Dallas Economic Development Corporation is prioritizing growth in southern and historically underinvested parts of the city. The most consequential single announcement of the current cycle is the Texas Stock Exchange (TXSE), which has secured regulatory approval and \$270 million in backing from Goldman Sachs, Bank of America, BlackRock, and Citadel among others, with trading targeted to begin in early 2026 — a development reinforcing Dallas's emerging identity as a national financial hub ("Y'all Street"). The Kay Bailey Hutchison Convention Center redevelopment, a roughly \$3.5 billion plan reshaping downtown's southern edge, is the city's largest single real estate bet. Corporate relocation and expansion activity includes a 200,000-square-foot Subaru/Prologis logistics expansion in Coppell (Dallas County's northwest corner) and continued office and headquarters relocations into the Manufacturing District and other targeted zones. The Dallas Wings' relocation to a renovated Memorial Auditorium, timed for the 2026 season, is a smaller but representative example of the city's venue-driven redevelopment strategy.



SWOT

Strength: unmatched concentration of corporate, financial, and transit infrastructure. Weakness: aging interstate infrastructure requiring sustained, expensive reconstruction rather than greenfield expansion. Opportunity: the I-345 corridor's long-term disposition and the Convention Center redevelopment represent decade-defining downtown land-use decisions. Threat: construction-phase congestion and cost inflation on multiple simultaneous megaprojects.

COLLIN COUNTY

Collin County remains the region's single most active economic development county, combining corporate relocations, a fast-growing airport, and the Dallas North Tollway's continued northward extension.

TRANSPORTATION

The Dallas North Tollway Phase 4 project extends the tollway 13.7 miles north of US-380, directly linking downtown Dallas to Collin and Denton counties' fastest-growing communities; Phase 4A — including mainlane construction and intersection work at Doe Branch Creek, Punk Carter Parkway, and the Collin County Outer Loop — is targeted to open in late 2027. The Sam Rayburn Tollway, NTTA's 26-mile east-west system linking Business 121 near the Dallas/Denton county line to US-75, continues to receive maintenance investment including pavement joint sealing under 2026 board-approved contracts. The Collin County Outer Loop, referenced directly in DNT Phase 4A construction, is itself an emerging long-range corridor for the county's northern and eastern growth.

ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT

McKinney is the current epicenter: Globe Life is relocating its headquarters and roughly 3,000 jobs to the city, Encore Wire has announced a \$500 million expansion adding an estimated 120 jobs, McKinney National Airport is undergoing a \$79 million expansion with commercial flight service targeted for 2026, and the \$300 million, 20,000-seat Sunset Amphitheater is also opening in 2026. Plano's growth centers on the Dallas Stars' planned \$3 billion sports and entertainment district (up to 2 million square feet of new office space) and the redevelopment of the former Collin Creek Mall site into a master-planned community for 5,000-plus residents. Frisco continues to add corporate relocations, including Public Storage's announced headquarters move.

WATER

Collin County cities are principal members of NTMWD and direct beneficiaries of the district's \$1.7 billion 2026 capital program described in Part I.



SWOT

Strength: the deepest, most diversified corporate relocation pipeline in the region. Weakness: land and infrastructure costs in the county's core (Plano, Frisco, McKinney) are now among the highest in Texas, pushing growth to the county's fringe. Opportunity: DNT Phase 4 and the Collin County Outer Loop open substantial new developable land in the county's north. Threat: water supply and school-capacity strain as growth continues to outpace the historical pace of infrastructure delivery.

DENTON COUNTY

Denton County's defining transportation story is the ongoing, multi-billion-dollar reconstruction of the I-35E/I-35W system, alongside the Dallas North Tollway's continued push north.

TRANSPORTATION

The I-35E/I-35W interchange project, a \$584 million, roughly five-year undertaking that began construction in January 2025, is widening the freeway and interchange and reconstructing 4-to-8 continuous frontage lanes. The related I-35 Denton County Connections project, running from North Texas Boulevard to US-77 north of Denton, is a \$583 million reconstruction from four to six lanes running January 2025 through August 2029 (29 percent complete as of the most recent reporting). Additional discrete I-35E projects include a \$117 million grade-separation and frontage-road reconstruction at FM 1171/Main Street (64 percent complete, targeting January 2027), an \$11.7 million bridge replacement east of US-377 (82 percent complete, targeting June 2026), and a \$218 million interchange reconstruction at Corporate Drive/SH 121 Business (19 percent complete, targeting July 2029) — together with other funded work totaling roughly \$1.1 billion in Denton County I-35 investment alone. The Dallas North Tollway's Phase 4 extension also runs through southeastern Denton County en route to the Collin/Grayson line.

ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT

Denton anchors the county with a diversified university and technology economy (UNT and TWU, combined roughly 50,000 students) and has drawn attention for converting a former Bitcoin-mining facility into one of North America's largest GPU supercomputers — a strong early signal of the AI-infrastructure investment wave reaching the county.



SWOT

Strength: the region's most active interstate reconstruction program, guaranteeing long-term capacity. Weakness: years of sustained construction-phase disruption along the I-35 spine. Opportunity: the Denton GPU-supercomputer conversion signals a new institutional demand category (AI/data-center) layering onto the county's existing university and logistics economy. Threat: construction cost and schedule risk across four concurrent, billion-dollar-plus I-35 phases.

TARRANT COUNTY

Tarrant County's program centers on the historic North Tarrant Express/I-35W corridor and the Southeast Connector's reconstruction of I-20 and I-820.

TRANSPORTATION

The \$1.6 billion North Tarrant Express (NTE)/I-35W project spans 10 miles through Fort Worth; earlier phases (I-35W north of I-820 to US-81/287, and north of I-30 to north of I-820) reached substantial completion in 2016 and 2018 respectively, and construction begun in fall 2020 continues on the segment from US-81/287 to Eagle Parkway, rebuilding 6.7 miles and adding four TEXpress managed lanes. The Southeast Connector, a \$2.3 billion project, is rebuilding and widening roughly 16 miles of I-20 and I-820 — widening I-20 to ten main lanes from I-820 to US-287 and I-820 to eight main lanes from I-20 to Spur 303 (Rosedale Street), and reconstructing the I-20/I-820/US-287 interchange complex. A separate I-820 Northwest Loop Corridor study is evaluating reconstruction of I-820, SH-199, and FM 1220/Azle Avenue with continuous frontage roads. The Chisholm Trail Parkway's \$250 million NTTA-funded widening from two to four lanes (Crowley Plover Road/FM 1187 to US-67) begins in Tarrant County before crossing into Johnson County.

TRANSIT

TEXRail (Fort Worth-to-DFW Airport commuter rail) and the Alliance master-planned industrial/logistics corridor in north Fort Worth continue to anchor the county's freight and transit infrastructure, complementing the DART Silver Line's western terminus at DFW Airport.



SWOT

Strength: Fort Worth is currently the fastest-growing large city in America, sustaining demand across every corridor in the county.
Weakness: the NTE/I-820/Southeast Connector program represents one of the most complex, multi-year construction footprints in the state. **Opportunity:** the Chisholm Trail Parkway widening unlocks southern Tarrant and northern Johnson County growth simultaneously. **Threat:** interchange-level construction complexity at the I-20/I-820/US-287 convergence carries elevated cost and schedule risk.

ROCKWALL COUNTY

Rockwall County — the wealthiest county in Texas by median income and largely lake-constrained — is executing a tightly focused set of projects addressing its most acute chokepoints.

TRANSPORTATION

I-30's second expansion segment crosses Lake Ray Hubbard from Dalrock Road to SH-205, widening from six to eight lanes and constructing continuous frontage roads across the lake to improve incident reliability — a direct response to the corridor's status as the primary bottleneck between Dallas and the fast-growing Hunt County towns beyond Rockwall. SH-205 (Goliad Street) is being improved from north of Olive Street to proposed SH-276, including a six-lane divided roadway between SH-276 and Denison Street, a one-way three-lane couplet along Alamo Road, a Union Pacific Railroad bridge replacement, and a Buffalo Creek culvert-to-bridge replacement; a pre-construction meeting was held April 20, 2026. Additional work targets the SH-276/FM-548 intersection redesign and SH-66 signal upgrades for capacity.



SWOT

Strength: the highest-income county in the state, with strong fiscal capacity to co-fund local improvements. Weakness: Lake Ray Hubbard constrains the county's developable land and concentrates all through-traffic onto a small number of crossings. Opportunity: SH-205 and I-30 improvements directly serve as the release valve pushing growth east into Hunt County. Threat: the county is close to built out; most of the appreciation upside from this cycle's projects will accrue just across the county line.



PART III: INNER RING COUNTIES



KAUFMAN COUNTY

Kaufman County, anchored by Forney and Terrell, is a textbook case of infrastructure funding struggling to keep pace with growth.

TRANSPORTATION

TxDOT is conducting a feasibility and alignment study on SH-34 from FM-2578 in Terrell to SH-243 in Kaufman, evaluating a four-lane divided roadway to address safety and traffic-flow demands from Terrell, Kaufman, and surrounding cities' growth.

A separate, currently active \$80 million project is upgrading FM-548 near Forney — converting the roadway from asphalt to concrete with additional travel lanes and drainage upgrades from north of US-80 to Windmill Farms Boulevard, running July 2025 through March 2027, directly relieving one of the county's fastest-growing corridors. The most consequential figure in the county's planning record, however, is the funding gap itself: local reporting identifies roughly \$3.8 billion in identified project needs against less than \$700 million in currently identified funding, explicitly excluding critical US-175 and I-20 main-lane improvements — a roughly \$4 billion backlog that is the central planning and advocacy issue for county and city officials (Terrell's city council has formally called for additional TxDOT funding).

ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT

Forney's rapid residential growth continues to be the county's headline story, with commercial and retail development following.



SWOT

Strength: direct US-80/I-20 and US-175 access to Dallas. Weakness: the largest identified funding gap of any county in this report relative to documented need. Opportunity: the SH-34 feasibility study and FM-548 project, if followed by comparable investment on US-175 and I-20, would materially re-rate the county's development capacity. Threat: continued underfunding relative to residential growth risks chronic congestion becoming a binding constraint on further rooftop development.

ELLIS COUNTY

Ellis County combines an active I-35E/US-287 highway program with what is likely the single largest private capital commitment of any county in this report: Google's data center buildout.

TRANSPORTATION

Roughly 30 planned mobility projects are active or programmed in Ellis County, including widening of FM-1387 and FM-663 and frontage-road/interchange construction on US-287 from east of SH-360 to US-67/Business 287 north of Waxahachie. A discrete I-35E improvement project spans roughly 11 miles from US-77 south of Waxahachie to US-77 north of Waxahachie. US-287 is being widened from two/four lanes to six lanes to FM-1987, a \$75 million project targeting September 2028 completion, and a separate \$13 million project spanning Johnson County to Midlothian Parkway addresses base repair and overlay work plus an added southbound exit-ramp lane at Old Fort Worth Road.

ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT

Google's Texas data center strategy is centered on Ellis County: the Midlothian campus, established in 2019, has been expanded multiple times with a fourth building now planned, and the Red Oak campus's first building became operational in late 2025. These campuses are part of Google's announced \$40 billion Texas investment (extending through 2027) spanning data centers, energy projects, and workforce development, alongside a \$30 million Energy Impact Fund launching in 2026 to help Texas communities with affordability and efficiency. The projects are expected to generate thousands of construction jobs and a smaller but durable base of permanent, high-paying technical positions.



SWOT

Strength: the clearest, most de-risked large-scale institutional capital commitment (Google) of any county in this report. Weakness: data-center employment, while high-wage, is capital- rather than labor-intensive and will not by itself drive the rooftop growth the county's highway program is designed for. Opportunity: Google's continued campus expansion (a fourth Midlothian building, ongoing Red Oak buildout) signals further investment is likely. Threat: data-center power and water demand at this scale will compete with residential and other industrial users for the same regional infrastructure described in Part I.

JOHNSON COUNTY

Johnson County is the clearest beneficiary of the Chisholm Trail Parkway's ongoing widening, with Cleburne and Burleson both undergoing significant mixed-use development.

TRANSPORTATION

The Chisholm Trail Parkway is being widened from two to four lanes across a 13-mile stretch from Crowley Plover Road/FM-1187 in Tarrant County to US-67 in Johnson County, a \$250 million project that began construction in summer 2025 and is targeted for completion by late 2028; NTTA's board approved the construction, project-management, and materials-testing contracts at its May 21 meeting. TxDOT is separately responsible for design and construction of the US-67 main lanes, frontage roads, and their tie-ins to the existing and proposed Chisholm Trail Parkway main lanes, and a US-67 Cleburne Bypass is in the NCTCOG project pipeline.

ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT

Cleburne Station, a 75-acre mixed-use public-private development at US-67 and the Chisholm Trail Parkway, will include 400,000 square feet of retail, up to six restaurant pad sites, commercial office space, a movie theater, and a hotel. In Burleson, rapidly growing I-35W and tollway traffic volumes are supporting Craftmasters (a trade school planned to serve roughly 5,000 students) and the Hooper Business Park.



SWOT

Strength: a funded, under-construction tollway widening directly serving both of the county's largest cities. Weakness: county-wide road capacity outside the Chisholm Trail corridor itself remains comparatively underdeveloped. Opportunity: Cleburne Station and the Burleson developments are early proof points that the corridor can support institutional-grade mixed-use investment. Threat: the county's growth to date has closely tracked a single corridor; diversifying beyond it will require additional county-level road investment.

PARKER COUNTY

Parker County is executing a multi-decade downtown-revitalization and highway-capacity program centered on Weatherford, while functioning as the western gateway to Fort Worth's continued expansion.

TRANSPORTATION

TxDOT is improving I-20 from FM-2552 (Santa Fe/Clear Lake Road) to East Bankhead Highway, with the broader "Keep 20-30 Moving" initiative implementing three projects to enhance I-20 and I-30 corridor mobility between Aledo and west Fort Worth across Tarrant and Parker counties. The US-180 bridge across the Brazos River is slated for replacement in 2026. The US-180 Northern Loop project, a joint City of Weatherford/NCTCOG venture, is the first of a four-phase long-term vision to revitalize historic downtown Weatherford — constructing a new northern loop for traffic circulation, a roundabout at the US-180 intersection, new bicycle lanes, and intersection improvements at FM-51.



SWOT

Strength: direct benefit from Fort Worth's westward growth and from a genuinely multi-phase, locally championed downtown revitalization plan. Weakness: much of the county's road network remains rural-scale relative to its growth trajectory. Opportunity: the Northern Loop's remaining three phases represent a long runway of continued public investment supporting downtown Weatherford land values. Threat: groundwater-dependent water supply across much of the county remains the binding long-term constraint on growth capacity, independent of road investment.

WISE COUNTY

Wise County is planning at a genuinely regional scale, with its "Wise Moves" thoroughfare master plan explicitly designed around a projected 127 percent population increase by 2050.

TRANSPORTATION

Large-scale, longer-term improvements include reconstructing the US-81/287 main lanes and frontage roads from Pioneer Road north of Rhome to Avondale-Haslet Road in Fort Worth, with new overpasses at County Road 4840 and Northstar Parkway, a new underpass at County Road 4843, and new direct connectors at SH-114. TxDOT is also proposing to realign FM-1810 and construct a new FM-1810/US-81/US-287 interchange. The Wise Moves plan itself proposes sixteen new thoroughfare corridors and multiple grade separations (six along US-287, one along SH-114 at FM-51) to ease congestion on US-380, US-81/287, and SH-114, with east-west connections linking US-287 and SH-114 via upgrades to Ramhorn Hill Road, FM-407, FM-2264, and FM-1810. County officials, including the County Judge and Decatur's city manager, have also begun studying the feasibility of upgrading US-287 to full Interstate Highway status.



SWOT

Strength: the most explicitly long-range, growth-driven thoroughfare planning of any county in this report, directly tied to a quantified 2050 population forecast. Weakness: nearly all of the plan's sixteen new corridors remain unfunded county-level proposals rather than TxDOT-committed projects. Opportunity: the US-287-to-Interstate feasibility discussion, if it advances, would be a step-change catalyst comparable to any single project elsewhere in this report. Threat: the gap between the county's stated 2050 growth expectations and its currently funded infrastructure is the widest of any county profiled here.



PART IV: NORTHERN AND NORTHEASTERN COUNTIES



HUNT COUNTY

Hunt County, anchored by Greenville and increasingly by the Royse City/FM-2642 growth node at its southwestern corner, is executing one of the largest I-30 investment programs in this report relative to its size.

TRANSPORTATION

Two major I-30 widening projects are active: a \$128 million-plus widening from four to six lanes spanning roughly one mile west of the I-30/FM-1903 intersection to just east of Monty Stratton Parkway, improving intersections at FM-1903, FM-1570, and Monty Stratton Parkway, targeting April 2026 completion; and a second, larger I-30 project awarded to Williams Brothers Construction at more than \$210 million with 945 working days, targeting August 2027. TxDOT is also conducting a roughly 20-mile SH-34 feasibility study from I-30 to CR-2312, addressing residential and commercial growth pressure on the corridor around Quinlan and Greenville.

ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT

Greenville EDC controls substantial available industrial land, positioning the city for continued industrial and logistics recruitment alongside its existing L3Harris aerospace/defense employment base. At the county's southwestern edge, the I-30/FM-2642 interchange — anchored by a Buc-ee's and drawing H-E-B interest for a nearby site — has become one of the most actively developing retail and commercial nodes in the entire region.



SWOT

Strength: two concurrent, well-funded I-30 widenings totaling well over \$300 million, directly serving the county's fastest-growing segment. **Weakness:** growth remains concentrated at the county's western edge (Royse City/Caddo Mills corridor) rather than distributed toward Greenville. **Opportunity:** the SH-34 feasibility study, if it advances to funded construction, would open the Quinlan-to-Greenville corridor to the same growth already visible near Royse City. **Threat:** Greenville's employment base, while stable, has not yet attracted the scale of new capital investment reshaping the county's western towns.

FANNIN COUNTY

Fannin County's development story is inseparable from Bois d'Arc Lake — the first major new reservoir built in Texas in nearly 30 years — and from Bonham's emergence as the county's primary growth center.

WATER AND LAKE DEVELOPMENT

Bois d'Arc Lake, located north of US-82 between Bonham and Honey Grove and serving NTMWD's thirteen member cities, officially opened in 2023; NTMWD projects the lake will generate roughly 2,400 new jobs and contribute approximately \$166 million annually in economic activity once fully built out, and the project has been recognized by the American Planning Association's Texas chapter for its land-use and zoning approach. Fannin County's Bois d'Arc Lake Zoning Commission continues to oversee shoreline development standards.

ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT.

Bonham's transformation is the county's clearest single case study: the Bonham Economic Development Corporation has detailed plans for Powder Creek Ranch, a 400-acre mixed-use master-planned community near the SH-121/SH-56 intersection in southwest Bonham, with Phase One (73 acres) in civil design and groundbreaking anticipated in late 2026. The City of Bonham and Fannin County have jointly created Tax Increment Reinvestment Zone (TIRZ) #3 to drive long-term redevelopment of downtown Bonham and its major highway corridors, and in May 2026 the city and county launched a combined \$74 million investment plan to revitalize downtown and highway infrastructure together.

TRANSPORTATION

US-82, the county's primary east-west corridor linking Sherman to Bonham, Honey Grove, and Paris, remains the subject of ongoing TxDOT planning attention as growth continues along the Bois d'Arc Lake corridor.



SWOT

Strength: a genuinely unique catalyst (a brand-new major reservoir) combined with an unusually coordinated city/county TIRZ and downtown-investment strategy. Weakness: infrastructure outside the immediate Bonham/lake corridor remains rural-scale. Opportunity: Powder Creek Ranch's Phase One groundbreaking (late 2026) is the clearest near-term signal event to watch for the entire county. Threat: the lake's projected \$166 million annual economic contribution assumes continued build-out pace that has not yet been fully tested through a complete development cycle.

MONTAGUE COUNTY

Montague County sits at the intersection of two major U.S. highway upgrade programs, positioning Bowie and Nocona as the county's primary beneficiaries.

TRANSPORTATION

US-82 is being upgraded from a two-lane undivided highway to a four-lane divided highway across roughly 27 miles from Henrietta to Nocona; the first phase (east of Ringgold to Nocona) was completed in June 2024, with the second phase underway and targeted for completion by the end of 2026. Separately, the southbound main lanes of US-287/US-81 are being reconstructed from Fruitland Road to the Montague/Wise County line, a project that began mid-February 2026 and is scheduled to run through July 2027. US-287 functions as the county's primary north-south artery, connecting Bowie south toward Wise County and Fort Worth and north toward Wichita Falls and Oklahoma via its overlap with US-82.



SWOT

Strength: two simultaneous four-lane upgrade programs on the county's two primary highways. Weakness: the county remains at the outer edge of the Metroplex's commuting and development range. Opportunity: full four-laning of both US-82 and US-287/81 by roughly 2026-2027 would meaningfully improve Bowie and Nocona's connectivity to both the Metroplex and Wichita Falls. Threat: without a comparable economic-development catalyst (the county has no announced project on the scale of Fannin's Bois d'Arc Lake or Ellis's Google campuses), highway investment alone may not be sufficient to accelerate growth on the timeline seen closer to the core Metroplex.

LAMAR COUNTY

Lamar County, anchored by Paris, is advancing two significant US-highway widening projects through TxDOT's Paris District.

TRANSPORTATION

US-271 is being widened from a two-lane to a four-lane divided highway from Loop 286 in Paris to SH-37 in Bogata, spanning Lamar and Red River counties, with construction anticipated to begin in spring 2026 — the more advanced of the county's two major projects. US-82 is separately being planned for widening from the Fannin County line to Loop 286 west of Paris, a project that had reached the public-meeting and planning stage as of the most recent reporting, without yet a confirmed construction start date.

ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT

Paris functions as the region's genuine hub city, with an existing manufacturing and healthcare employment base (including Campbell's Soup, Kimberly-Clark, and Paris Regional Health among the area's larger employers) and a historic downtown square anchoring its own smaller-scale revitalization efforts.



SWOT

Strength: an existing diversified employment base (food processing, consumer products, healthcare) uncommon among comparably sized outer-ring counties. Weakness: sits at the far edge of the 60-mile radius, roughly 100 miles from downtown Dallas by road, limiting direct commuting relationship to the core Metroplex. Opportunity: the US-271 widening, once funded and under construction beginning spring 2026, directly improves connectivity toward the Bois d'Arc Lake corridor and the rest of northeast Texas. Threat: the US-82 west widening remains in early planning, and without it, Paris's connectivity to the Sherman/Bonham growth corridor immediately to its west will continue to lag behind the pace of development there.

GRAYSON AND COOKE COUNTIES (EXTENDED WATCH TIER)

Though at the edge of the 60-mile radius, Grayson and Cooke counties are included because both sit directly on corridors already profiled at length in this report's companion research and warrant a brief update here.

GRAYSON COUNTY

A \$155 million US-75 project from FM-1417 to Texoma Parkway is essentially complete; a further FM-1417 (SH-56 to US-75) widening from two to four lanes is programmed to begin in 2026, alongside a \$100 million-plus Loy Lake Road improvement between Denison and Sherman (targeting 2027) and an approximately \$80 million US-75 segment from the Collin County line to FM-902. Most notably, a proposed 33-mile Grayson County Tollway is under formal TxDOT study as a new high-speed regional corridor — a project that, if it advances, would be the most significant new-terrain infrastructure commitment anywhere in this report's northern tier, layering directly onto the county's existing Texas Instruments/GlobiTech semiconductor investment.

COOKE COUNTY

County-level thoroughfare planning continues, anchored by the I-35 corridor's continued widening (see Denton County above, as the same TxDOT program extends north) and by Gainesville's BNSF industrial rail park and related logistics investment.



PART V: EXTENDED WATCH TIER COUNTIES



The counties below sit at or beyond the outer edge of the 60-mile radius but each intersects a corridor already central to this report, or shows early signals worth tracking as the region's growth continues to push outward.

HOOD COUNTY

Hood County (Granbury) is weighing a \$717 million road program — a striking figure for a county of its size, reflecting the same growth pressure reshaping Parker and Johnson counties to its north and east. The program remains in the funding and planning stage; the coming twelve to twenty-four months of county commissioner action will determine which segments move to construction first.

NAVARRO COUNTY

Navarro County (Corsicana), positioned along I-45 southeast of the core Metroplex, continues active but incremental economic development efforts through the Corsicana & Navarro County Chamber of Commerce and the city's economic development office. No single project of the scale seen in Ellis, Fannin, or Grayson counties has yet been publicly announced for Navarro County as of this report; it remains a county to monitor rather than a current-cycle priority, though its I-45 position and available industrial land make it a plausible beneficiary of continued southward Metroplex expansion and of overflow demand from the Austin-area semiconductor corridor to its south.

VAN ZANDT, HOPKINS, AND DELTA COUNTIES

These three counties sit along the I-30/US-80/I-20 eastern corridor and are earlier-stage than any county profiled in Parts II through IV. TxDOT's Tyler District is developing preliminary plans for a roughly 82-mile I-20 widening and reconstruction corridor spanning Smith, Gregg, and Van Zandt counties from the Kaufman County line east to the Harrison County line — including ramp reconstruction and mainlane/frontage-road bridge replacement aimed at safety and long-term congestion relief. In Hopkins County, current TxDOT activity is limited to maintenance-scale work (pavement repairs on the I-30 north frontage road at Exit 122). Delta County's current activity is similarly maintenance-scale, centered on bridge rail upgrades and bridge maintenance on SH-19/24 between Lamar and Delta counties. None of the three currently has a funded, under-construction major project comparable to those profiled elsewhere in this report, but each sits on a corridor (I-20 east, US-82/I-30 toward Sulphur Springs) where this report's companion research has already identified major private capital commitments immediately adjacent — most notably the multi-billion-dollar AI data center campus under construction in Sulphur Springs, Hopkins County's neighbor to the immediate east.

PART VI: CROSS-COUNTY THEMES AND IMPLICATIONS



THE FUNDING-CONFIDENCE GRADIENT

Reading across all eighteen counties, a clear gradient emerges from "funded and under construction" to "aspirational and unfunded." Dallas, Collin, Denton, Tarrant, and Rockwall counties account for the overwhelming majority of dollars actually under contract today. Kaufman, Ellis, Johnson, Parker, and Wise counties show a mix of active construction and near-term funded projects, with Wise County's ambitious 2050 thoroughfare vision the clearest example of a county planning well ahead of its current funding.

Hunt, Fannin, Montague, and Lamar counties show real, funded highway investment (particularly Hunt County's twin I-30 projects and Montague's dual US-highway upgrades) paired with earlier-stage economic-development catalysts. The extended watch tier — Hood, Navarro, Van Zandt, Hopkins, and Delta — remains predominantly at the planning or maintenance stage. This gradient is not a criticism of any single county's planning; it is simply the observable, current-state map of where public capital has already committed versus where it is still being sought.

WATER AS THE EMERGING GATING CONSTRAINT

NTMWD's \$1.7 billion 2026 capital program, and in particular the Bois d'Arc Lake and Texoma Two-Step pipeline investments described in Part I, is quietly becoming as important a variable as highway capacity for every county in this report's northern and eastern tiers. Fannin County's Bonham growth story is directly downstream of Bois d'Arc Lake; Collin County's continued expansion depends on the same district's broader supply program; and Parker County's western-edge growth remains constrained by groundwater-dependent supply in a way that no highway project can resolve. Any investor, developer, or public official evaluating a specific project in this report should treat the relevant water utility's capital plan and CCN (Certificate of Convenience and Necessity) status as co-equal diligence items alongside the highway and tollway projects that more visibly define this report's structure.

PRIVATE CAPITAL IS NOW SETTING THE PACE

Several of the single largest commitments identified across all eighteen counties are private, not public: Google's \$40 billion Texas investment centered on Ellis County, the \$18-billion-plus AI data center campus under construction adjacent to this report's eastern watch-tier counties, Globe Life's headquarters relocation and Encore Wire's \$500 million McKinney expansion, and Texas Instruments' and GlobiTech's combined roughly \$45 billion Grayson County semiconductor investment (referenced in this report's Grayson County update and treated in full in this firm's companion research).

In each case, the public infrastructure programs profiled in this report — highway widenings, tollway extensions, water pipelines — function as necessary but not sufficient conditions: they are what makes a county eligible to receive this scale of private investment, but the investment decision itself is being driven by power, water, fiber, and labor-market fundamentals that increasingly sit outside the traditional transportation-planning process entirely.

WHAT TO WATCH NEXT

Five specific events, drawn directly from the current planning record, are the highest-value near-term signals for anyone tracking this region: the October 2026 NTMWD pipeline construction contract awards (Texoma Two-Step); the late-2026/early-2027 opening of DNT Phase 4A and its effect on southern Grayson County; the Grayson County Tollway's advancement from study to funded status; the Powder Creek Ranch Phase One groundbreaking in Bonham; and the outcome of Wise County's US-287-to-Interstate feasibility discussion. Each would independently justify a follow-up report on its own.

APPENDIX

APPENDIX A: CONSOLIDATED PROJECT TRACKER

County	Project	Agency	Est. Value	Status
Dallas	I-30 Canyon (downtown reconstruction)	TxDOT	Part of \$800M+ county program	Under construction
Dallas	Southern Gateway (I-35E rebuild)	TxDOT	\$666M	Substantially complete; deck park spring 2026
Dallas	I-345 bridge widening/maintenance	TxDOT	\$20.5M	Funded
Dallas	US-175 rehabilitation	TxDOT	\$28.7M	Funded
Collin	Dallas North Tollway Phase 4A	NTTA	~\$450M	Under construction; opens late 2027
Collin	McKinney National Airport expansion	City/Private	\$79M	Commercial service targeted 2026
Denton	I-35E/I-35W interchange	TxDOT	\$584M	Under construction through ~2029/2030
Denton	I-35 Denton County Connections	TxDOT	\$583M	29% complete; through Aug. 2029
Tarrant	North Tarrant Express/I-35W	TxDOT/NTE Mobility	\$1.6B	Phased; active construction
Tarrant	Southeast Connector (I-20/I-820)	TxDOT	\$2.3B	Active
Rockwall	I-30 Segment 2 (Dalrock Rd-SH 205)	TxDOT	Part of broader I-30 program	Under construction

County	Project	Agency	Est. Value	Status
Rockwall	SH-205 (Goliad St.) improvements	TxDOT	TBD	Pre-construction (April 2026 meeting)
Kaufman	FM-548 upgrade near Forney	TxDOT	\$80M	Under construction; through March 2027
Kaufman	SH-34 feasibility study	TxDOT	TBD	Study phase
Ellis	US-287 widening to FM-1987	TxDOT	\$75M	Under construction; targets Sept. 2028
Ellis	Google Midlothian/Red Oak data centers	Private	Part of \$40B TX investment	Operational; expanding
Johnson	Chisholm Trail Parkway widening	NTTA	\$250M	Under construction; targets late 2028
Johnson	Cleburne Station mixed-use	Private/Public	TBD	Under construction
Parker	I-20 improvements (FM-2552 to E. Bankhead)	TxDOT	TBD	Programmed
Parker	US-180 Northern Loop (Weatherford)	City/NCTCOG	TBD	Phase 1 of 4
Wise	US-81/287 main lane reconstruction	TxDOT	TBD	Programmed
Wise	Wise Moves thoroughfare plan (16 corridors)	County	TBD	Planning phase
Hunt	I-30 widening (FM-1903 to Monty Stratton Pkwy)	TxDOT	\$128M+	Targets April 2026
Hunt	I-30 widening (Williams Bros. contract)	TxDOT	\$210M+	Targets August 2027
Fannin	Bois d'Arc Lake / Powder Creek Ranch	NTMWD/City of Bonham	TIRZ #3 + \$74M downtown plan	Phase 1 groundbreaking late 2026

County	Project	Agency	Est. Value	Status
Montague	US-82 widening (Henrietta-Nocona)	TxDOT	TBD	Phase 2 targets end of 2026
Montague	US-287/81 southbound reconstruction	TxDOT	TBD	Feb. 2026-July 2027
Lamar	US-271 widening (Loop 286-SH 37)	TxDOT	TBD	Construction begins spring 2026
Lamar	US-82 widening (Fannin Co. line-Loop 286)	TxDOT	TBD	Planning/public meeting phase
Grayson	Grayson County Tollway	TxDOT (study)	TBD	Formal study phase
Grayson	US-75 (FM-1417-Texoma Pkwy)	TxDOT	\$155M	Substantially complete
Regional	NTMWD Texoma Two-Step pipelines	NTMWD	\$605M x2	Contracts awarded Oct. 2026
Regional	NTMWD Bois d'Arc Lake east pipeline	NTMWD	\$240M	Part of FY26 capital program
Regional	DART Silver Line (Cotton Belt)	DART	Major	~85% complete; opening late 2025/early 2026

APPENDIX B: SOURCES

TxDOT Unified Transportation Program (2026 draft and adopted cycles); TxDOT Dallas, Fort Worth, Paris, and Wichita Falls district construction and design project lists and individual project fact sheets; TxDOT public hearing and public meeting notices for projects cited above. North Texas Tollway Authority board of directors meeting agendas (2026 cycle) and project progress reports for the Dallas North Tollway and Chisholm Trail Parkway.

North Central Texas Council of Governments, Mobility 2050: The Metropolitan Transportation Plan for North Central Texas (adopted June 12, 2025) and its 2026 administrative revisions and Regional 10-Year Plan updates. North Texas Municipal Water District FY2026 capital improvement program announcements and Bois d'Arc Lake program materials. City and county economic development corporation announcements and council actions for Dallas, McKinney, Plano, Frisco, Bonham, Terrell, Weatherford, Decatur, Greenville, Corsicana, and Paris. Additional reporting from Dallas Innovates, D CEO Magazine, the Fort Worth Report, Bisnow Dallas-Fort Worth, the Wise County Messenger, the Herald-Banner (Greenville), the Rockwall Herald-Banner, the Paris News, and county-level outlets cited throughout. All figures current as of mid-2026 and subject to revision; verify current status directly with the responsible agency before relying on any figure for investment or planning decisions.

ABOUT THIS REPORT

This report synthesizes publicly available TxDOT, NTTA, NCTCOG, NTMWD, and municipal economic development records to profile major infrastructure and economic development activity across eighteen North Texas counties within approximately 60 miles of Dallas County. It is provided for informational purposes and does not constitute investment, legal, engineering, or tax advice. Public infrastructure budgets, timelines, and scopes are routinely revised; verify all figures against current primary sources before relying on them. © 2026. All rights reserved.



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